

- Do not make alcohol the focus of your event
- If you have had too much alcohol, stop drinking several hours before you intend to leave so your body can begin to lower your BAC

QUESTIONS

Before you move on to Chapter 10, make sure you can answer these questions:

- How does impaired driving rank as a high-way safety problem?
- What are the effects of alcohol on the skills you need to drive?
- Which of these drugs could affect your ability to drive: marijuana, a cold remedy, a tranquilizer?
- If you take a non-prescription drug, what must you do before you drive?
- What is a likely effect when you take another drug while you drink beverages containing alcohol?
- On what three conditions does your blood alcohol content (BAC) depend?
- Which of these contains more alcohol than the other three: 1-1/2 ounces (30 ml) of liquor, five ounces (120 ml) wine, 12 ounces (360 ml) of beer, 12 ounces (360 ml) of wine cooler?
- On average, how long does it take your body to remove the alcohol contained in 12 ounces of beer?
- What is the only effective method to reduce your BAC?
- What happens to your driver license if you refuse a chemical test?
- Other than fines, action against your driver license and a possible jail term, what are some of the results when you drive under the influence of alcohol or other drugs?

CHAPTER 10 /SPECIAL DRIVING CONDITIONS

Even under the best conditions, driving requires your full attention and your best judgment. When special conditions or hazards occur, attention and judgment become even more important. To be a good and safe driver, you must learn how to drive on expressways, at night, in bad weather and when an emergency occurs.

RAILROAD CROSSINGS

GRADE CROSSINGS

A grade crossing is the point at which train tracks intersect with a roadway and is considered an intersection. As you approach a crossing, always expect a train. Trains can run on any track, at any time, from either direction. Never race a train to a crossing, never drive around lowered gates, and do not stop on tracks. (You will learn later in the section what to do if your vehicle stalls or gets stuck on a track.) When crossing tracks, always stay in your lane and in the same gear.

Some grade crossings have flashing red lights or lowering gates when a train approaches ("active" grade crossings). When approaching marked, or active, grade crossings, do not proceed until the gates are completely raised and the lights are off. It is illegal and dangerous to go around lowered gates or to cross while the lights are still flashing.

Some grade crossings do not have gates or flashing lights. When approaching unmarked, or passive, grade crossings, slow down and be prepared to stop. Before you cross, be sure that a train is not coming. If you see a train coming, wait until it passes, and then cross the tracks when it is safe to do so. If there are multiple tracks, wait until you can clearly see down all sets of tracks in both directions for another approaching train before crossing.

Remember that the train you see is closer and faster-moving than you think, and be aware that trains cannot stop quickly.